

Word family: **side / sides / sided / siding / sideways / side-by-side / sideline / side effect / downside / upside**

Base word: side

Plural: sides

Related forms: sided, siding, sideways

Useful family extensions: side-by-side, sideline, side effect, downside, upside

Part of speech: mainly noun (名詞) / adjective-like modifier (名詞作修飾語) / verb in some uses (動詞)

Your sentence:

> “An old person I know well is my grandmother on my mother's **side**.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **side** means **one branch or part of a family, identified through one parent**.

So:

> **my mother's side**

means:

> the relatives connected to me through my mother.

It does **not** mean a physical left/right side.

繁體中文： ** **家族中的其中一支，即透過父親或母親所連繫的親屬一方

**中文翻譯： **

> “An old person I know well is my grandmother on my mother's side.”

「我很熟悉的一位年長人士，是我**媽媽那邊 / 母系家族那邊**的外婆。」

Here:

my mother's side = 我母親這一邊的家族 / 透過母親與我有親屬關係的一方

1. **side of the family (家族的一方) — 家族中的某一支；父系 / 母系那邊**

This is the exact meaning in your passage.

Practice 1 — Original

> “An old person I know well is my grandmother on my mother's **side**.”

「我很熟悉的一位年長人士，是我**媽媽那邊的**外婆。」

Practice 2

> “Most of my cousins on my father's **side** live abroad.”

「我**爸爸那邊的家族**中，大部分表 / 堂兄弟姊妹都住在外國。」

Practice 3

> “She inherited that tradition from her mother's **side of the family**.”

「她從**母系家族那邊**承襲了這項傳統。」

****side of the family = 家族中透過其中一位父母所連結的一支親屬****

Common:

* **my mother's side** = 母親那邊的家族

* **my father's side** = 父親那邊的家族

2. ****side = one of the surfaces or outer parts of something (物體的一面 / 一邊) — 側面；一面****

This is the basic physical meaning.

Practice 4

> “There is a door on the **side** of the building.”

「建築物的**側面**有一道門。」

Practice 5

> “Write your name on the other **side** of the paper.”

「請在紙的**另一面**寫上你的名字。」

****side = 物體的一個表面、邊面或外側部分****

3. **side = left or right part (左邊 / 右邊) — 一側 ; 一邊**

Practice 6

> “She sat on the left **side** of the room.”

「她坐在房間的**左邊**。」

Practice 7

> “The pain is mostly on one **side** of my neck.”

「痛楚主要集中在我頸部的**一側**。」

****side = 某個人、物件或空間的左邊或右邊部分****

This is one of the most common physical uses.

4. **side of a person/body (身體的一側) — 身體側面 ; 腰側 / 身旁**

Practice 8

> “He lay on his **side**.”

「他**側身躺著**。」

Practice 9

> “She felt a sharp pain in her **side**.”

「她感到**身體側邊 / 腰側**一陣劇痛。」

****side = 人體由腋下到髖部附近的側面部分，或整個身體的一側****

This bodily use is more specific than the general left/right meaning.

5. **side = edge or boundary area (邊緣 / 旁邊) — 邊 ; 旁邊**

Practice 10

> “We stood at the **side** of the road.”

「我們站在**路邊**。」

Practice 11

> “She left her bag at the **side** of the chair.”

「她把袋子放在椅子的**旁邊**。」

side = 某個地方或物件接近邊緣、外圍或旁邊的位置

Common compounds:

* roadside

* bedside

* poolside

* ringside

These are useful extensions built from the same spatial idea.

6. **side** = one of two opposing groups (對立的一方) — 一方；陣營

This is a major figurative meaning.

Practice 12

> “Both **sides** agreed to continue the discussion.”

「**雙方**都同意繼續討論。」

Practice 13

> “Neither **side** was willing to compromise.”

「**任何一方**都不願意妥協。」

side = 在爭議、談判、衝突或競爭中持有某種立場的一方

Common:

* both sides = 雙方

* the other side = 另一方

* opposing sides = 對立雙方

7. ****take someone's side** — 支持某一方；站在某人那邊******

A very important fixed expression.

Practice 14

> “I don't want to ****take sides**** in their argument.”

「我不想在他們的爭論中****選邊站 / 偏幫任何一方****。」

Practice 15

> “She always ****takes her brother's side****.”

「她總是****站在她哥哥那邊 / 偏幫哥哥****。」

****take someone's side** = 在爭議或衝突中支持某人或某一方******

And:

****take sides** = 選擇支持其中一方******

8. ****side** = team in a game or competition (隊伍) — 隊；一方******

Especially common in British English and sports.

Practice 16

> “Our ****side**** played very well in the second half.”

「我們這****一隊****在下半場表現得很好。」

Practice 17

> “The home ****side**** scored first.”

「****主隊****首先入球。」

****side** = 在比賽或競賽中參與的一隊 / 一方******

This is particularly common in sports reporting.

9. **side** = viewpoint / position in an argument (觀點 / 立場) — 一方的說法 ; 立場

Closely related to opposing groups, but the focus is on the **argument or perspective** rather than the people themselves.

Practice 18

> “You should listen to both **sides** of the argument.”

「你應該聽取這場爭論的**雙方觀點**。」

Practice 19

> “I understand your **side** of the story.”

「我明白你對這件事的**說法 / 立場**。」

side = 對某件有爭議的事情所持的觀點、說法或立場

10. **side** = aspect / part of a person or thing (某個面向) — 一面 ; 一方面

Another important figurative use.

Practice 20

> “She has a very serious **side**.”

「她有**很嚴肅的一面**。」

Practice 21

> “The job has a creative **side** as well.”

「這份工作也有**創意的一面**。」

side = 某人性格、某件事情或某個情況的一個面向 / 特點

Common:

* serious side

* funny side

* practical side
* emotional side

11. **another side of someone/something — 不同的一面；另一個面貌**

Practice 22

> “Travelling together showed me another **side** of her.”

「一起旅行讓我看到她**另一面**。」

Practice 23

> “The documentary shows a darker **side** of the industry.”

「這套紀錄片展示了這個行業**較黑暗的一面**。」

another side = 某人 / 某事物平時不一定明顯的另一個面向或特質

This is especially common when describing personality or institutions.

12. **on the positive/negative side — 從正面 / 負面來看**

A useful evaluative expression.

Practice 24

> “On the positive **side**, the apartment is very quiet.”

「**從好的一面來看**，這個單位非常安靜。」

Practice 25

> “On the negative **side**, it is quite far from the station.”

「**從負面來看**，它離車站相當遠。」

on the positive/negative side = 從有利 / 不利的角度來看

This is common in balanced evaluations.

13. **on the side = in addition to one's main activity (副業 / 另外) — 兼職地 ; 額外地**

A common fixed expression.

Practice 26

> “She teaches during the day and sells handmade jewellery **on the side**.”

「她白天教書，另外還**兼做**手工首飾生意。」

Practice 27

> “He does some freelance design work **on the side**.”

「他另外也**兼職**做一些自由接案的設計工作**。」

on the side = 除了主要工作或活動之外，另外進行某件事

14. **on the side = served separately (食物另外放) — 另外盛放 ; 放在旁邊**

Another established use of the same expression.

Practice 28

> “Can I have the sauce **on the side**?”

「醬汁可以**另外放 / 分開上**嗎？」

Practice 29

> “The salad was served **on the side**.”

「沙律是**另外放在旁邊一起上桌的**。」

on the side = 食物或醬汁不直接混在主菜中，而是分開盛放

This is very common in restaurants.

15. **by someone's side / at someone's side — 在某人身邊 ; 陪伴某人**

Practice 30

> “Her family stayed ****by her side**** throughout the difficult period.”

「在那段艱難時期，她的家人一直****陪伴在她身邊****。」

Practice 31

> “He sat quietly ****at his grandmother's side****.”

「他安靜地坐在祖母****身旁****。」

****by/at someone's side = 在某人旁邊；常延伸為陪伴、支持某人****

The expression can be literal or emotional.

16. ****side by side = next to each other (並排地) — 並排；肩並肩****

Practice 32

> “They sat ****side by side**** on the bench.”

「他們****並排****坐在長椅上。」

Practice 33

> “The two photographs were displayed ****side by side****.”

「兩張照片****並排****展示。」

****side by side = 兩個或以上的人 / 物彼此緊鄰地排列****

Figuratively, it can also suggest cooperation:

> “They worked side by side.”

= 「他們並肩合作。」

17. ****side effect = unintended secondary result (副作用) — 副作用；附帶影響****

A major lexical extension.

Practice 34

> “The medicine may cause mild **side effects**.”

「這種藥可能引起輕微**副作用**。」

Practice 35

> “One **side effect** of working from home is feeling isolated.”

「在家工作的其中一個**附帶影響**是可能感到孤立。」

side effect = 某項行動、處理或藥物主要效果以外所產生的附帶結果

In medicine, it is especially common.

18. **downside** = disadvantage (缺點) — 缺點 ; 不利之處

A useful family extension built from **side**.

Practice 36

> “The main **downside** is the high price.”

「主要的**缺點 / 不利之處**是價格太高。」

Practice 37

> “Every option has a **downside**.”

「每個選擇都有其**缺點**。」

downside = 某件事情不理想、造成不便或不利的一面

19. **upside** = advantage / positive aspect (優點) — 好處 ; 有利之處

Practice 38

> “The **upside** is that you can work from anywhere.”

「**好處**是你可以在任何地方工作。」

Practice 39

> “There is a significant **upside** to learning the skill early.”

「提早學會這項技能有很大的**好處**。」

upside = 某件事情正面、有利或有價值的一面

Compare:

* **upside** = 優點 / 好處

* **downside** = 缺點 / 壞處

20. **sideline** = line at the side of a sports field (場邊線) — 邊線

Practice 40

> “The coach stood near the **sideline**.”

「教練站在球場**邊線**附近。」

Practice 41

> “The player stepped over the **sideline**.”

「球員踏過了**邊線**。」

sideline = 運動場地兩側用來標示比賽範圍的線

21. **sideline** = secondary job/activity (副業 / 次要活動) — 副業；兼職活動

The compound has developed another common meaning.

Practice 42

> “Photography started as a **sideline** but later became her full-time job.”

「攝影最初只是她的**副業**，後來卻成為全職工作。」

Practice 43

> “He runs a small online business as a **sideline**.”

「他把經營小型網上生意當作**副業**。」

****sideline = 主要工作或活動以外的次要工作 / 收入來源****

22. ****sideline — verb = remove from active participation (使無法參與) — 使退出；使暫停參與****

Practice 44

> “The injury ****sidelined**** him for several weeks.”

「傷勢令他****幾個星期無法參賽****。」

Practice 45

> “She was ****sidelined**** from the project after the disagreement.”

「爭議過後，她被****排除在這個項目的主要工作之外****。」

****sideline someone = 使某人不能繼續積極參與某項活動、比賽或工作****

This is a figurative development from being moved away from the main field of action.

23. ****side with + person/group — 支持；站在……一方****

Here ****side**** functions as a verb.

Practice 46

> “She ****sided with**** her brother during the disagreement.”

「在爭議中，她****站在哥哥那一方****。」

Practice 47

> “Most members ****sided with**** the manager.”

「大部分成員都****支持經理那一方****。」

****side with someone = 在爭議、衝突或選擇中支持某人 / 某一方****

This is different grammatically from noun ****side****, but clearly belongs to the same semantic family.

24. **side against + person/group — 站在.....的對立面**

Less frequent than **side with**, but useful.

Practice 48

> “He was surprised when his closest colleague **sided against** him.”

「當最親近的同事**站到他的對立面**時，他十分驚訝。」

Practice 49

> “Several members **sided against** the proposal.”

「幾位成員都**站在反對該提案的一方**。」

side against = 在爭議中選擇支持另一方，因此反對某人或某事

25. **sideways = toward or from the side (向側面) — 向側面地；橫向地**

A useful related form.

Practice 50

> “She moved **sideways** to let him pass.”

「她**向旁邊移動**，讓他通過。」

Practice 51

> “The car slid **sideways** on the wet road.”

「汽車在濕滑路面上**橫向滑行**。」

sideways = 朝側面方向移動或面向側面，而不是向前或向後

Important distinction: **side vs edge**

side

can mean a broad surface or one half/direction of something.

> “the side of the building”

= 建築物的側面

edge

means the actual outer boundary.

> “the edge of the table”

= 桌子的邊緣

So:

side = 面 / 一側

edge = 最外圍的邊界

Important distinction: **side vs part**

part

is very general:

> any section or component of a whole.

side

often suggests:

- * left/right division
- * opposing position
- * one aspect
- * one branch

For example:

> “the emotional side of her personality”

is natural because it means one **aspect**.

Important distinction: ****mother's side vs mother's family****

These overlap strongly.

****my mother's family****

= my mother's relatives

****my mother's side of the family****

= the branch of my family connected through my mother

The second expression explicitly contrasts that branch with:

> ****my father's side****

So ****side**** highlights the ****two family branches****.

Important distinction: ****side vs point of view****

****side****

often means one of the competing positions in a disagreement.

> "I understand his side."

****point of view****

means an individual's perspective or way of seeing something.

> "I understand his point of view."

They overlap, but ****side**** more strongly suggests a dispute with different camps.

Important distinction: ****take someone's side vs side with someone****

These are very close in meaning.

****take someone's side****

> "She took my side."

= 她站在我這邊。

side with someone

> “She sided with me.”

= 她支持我這一方。

The first uses **side** as a noun; the second uses it as a verb.

Important distinction: **side effect vs effect**

effect

= any result or consequence.

side effect

= a secondary result outside the main intended effect.

> “The medicine reduced pain.”

= main effect

> “It also caused sleepiness.”

= possible side effect

So **side** contributes the idea of:

> secondary / additional rather than primary.

Important distinction: **upside vs downside**

upside

= positive feature / advantage

downside

= negative feature / disadvantage

> “The upside is flexibility.”

「好處是彈性。」

> “The downside is lower pay.”

「缺點是薪酬較低。」

They form a very useful contrast pair.

Family-extension note

Following the reference style, these are especially useful members and constructions of the **side** family:

- * **mother's/father's side** = 母系 / 父系家族那邊
- * **side of an object** = 側面 / 一面
- * **left/right side** = 左 / 右邊
- * **one side of the body** = 身體的一側
- * **side of the road** = 路邊
- * **both sides** = 雙方
- * **side of an argument/story** = 某一方的觀點 / 說法
- * **take someone's side** = 支持某一方
- * **take sides** = 選邊站
- * **side with someone** = 支持某人一方
- * **another side of someone** = 某人的另一面
- * **positive/negative side** = 正面 / 負面的一面
- * **on the side — extra activity** = 另外兼做
- * **on the side — food** = 分開上菜 / 另外放
- * **by someone's side** = 在某人身旁 / 陪伴某人
- * **side by side** = 並排 / 並肩
- * **side effect** = 副作用 / 附帶影響
- * **upside** = 好處
- * **downside** = 缺點
- * **sideline — sports line** = 邊線
- * **sideline — secondary work** = 副業
- * **sideline — verb** = 使不能參與主要活動
- * **sideways** = 向側面地

As the reference format demonstrates, compounds and lexical extensions can be included when they add real learning value, but they should not all be treated as unrelated meanings of the bare base word.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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mother's/father's side	透過母親 / 父親所連結的家族其中一支
side — surface	物體的一個側面、表面或外側部分
left/right side	某個人、物件或空間的左邊 / 右邊部分
side — body	人體的側面部分，尤其軀幹一側
side — edge/nearby area	接近某個地方或物件邊緣的位置；旁邊
side — opposing group	在爭議、談判、衝突或競爭中的其中一方
side — sports team	在比賽或競賽中參與的一隊 / 一方
side of an argument/story	某場爭議中的觀點、立場或一方的說法
side — aspect	某人性格或某件事情的一個面向
another side	平時未必明顯的另一個面貌或特質
take someone's side	在爭議中支持某人 / 某一方
side with someone	以動詞表示支持某人 / 某一陣營
on the positive/negative side	從有利 / 不利的角度來看
on the side — extra work	在主要工作以外另外進行的副業 / 活動
on the side — food	食物或醬汁分開盛放，而非混在主菜中
by someone's side	在某人身旁；常延伸為陪伴及支持某人
side by side	彼此緊鄰並排；也可表示並肩合作
side effect	主要效果之外產生的次要 / 附帶結果
upside	某件事情有利、正面的一面
downside	某件事情不利、負面的一面
sideline — sports	運動場地兩側界定比賽範圍的邊線
sideline — secondary activity	主業以外的副業或次要活動
sideline — verb	使某人暫時或長期不能參與主要活動
sideways	朝側面方向，而非向前或向後

For your original sentence

> “An old person I know well is my grandmother on my mother's **side**.”

The exact meaning is:

side = 家族中透過其中一位父母所連結的一支親屬

Therefore:

> **my mother's side**

= “我媽媽那邊的家族 / 母系家族那一邊”

So the sentence identifies **which branch of the family** the grandmother belongs to.

In this context, ****side**** does not describe physical position at all. It figuratively organizes a family into two relational branches:

> ****mother's side ↔ father's side****

That family-branch meaning is the key polysemy point here.